

Day 5 — Ginger — Warming Root

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: distinguish fresh vs dried; gingerol vs shogaol.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *ārdraka* (IAST: ārdraḥ; lit. “ginger — *Zingiber officinale*”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Botanical identification.** *Zingiber officinale*. Rhizome (like turmeric, not a true root). Light tan skin. Fresh (*ārdraka*) vs dried (*śuṇṭhī*) — distinct Sanskrit names because the properties differ.
2. **Active compounds.** Fresh ginger: gingerols. Dried ginger: shogaols (gingerols dehydrate during drying). Both are pungent / “hot.”
3. **Traditional vs modern uses.** Caraka cites ginger for: digestive fire, nausea, cold-induced cough. Modern clinical trials support: nausea (motion sickness, chemo-induced — *Cochrane Reviews*), and mild anti-inflammatory effect.
4. **Two preparations, two effects.** “*Why does Āyurveda distinguish fresh from dried?*” Fresh ginger is heating but mild; dried ginger is more concentrated and warming. Modern: same compound family, different ratios.
5. **Activity.** Smell-test: fresh ginger root vs dried ginger powder. Students rate intensity 1-5 and write one sentence on the difference.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Ginger — Warming Root.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See homework.md for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 pañcabhūta).